Roberta Muri

Ph.D. Candidate in Economics, University of Bologna (Italy)

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Research Interests: Environmental Economics, Applied Microeconomics

Positions

California Institute of Technology (Caltech), USA
Postdoctoral Research Associate — From Jan 2027
Visiting Researcher, advisor Hannah Druckenmiller — Feb 2026 – Jul 2026

University of Bologna, Italy
Ph.D. Candidate in Economics — Nov 2022 – Dec 2026
Thesis: *Essays in Environmental Economics: Public Policies, Climate Adaptation, and Spatial Effects*
Supervisors: Lorenzo Forni and Vincenzo Scrutinio

Prometeia Think Tank, Italy
Economist — May 2022 – Present

Job Market Paper

Firms Under Water: Floods, Adaptation and Performance

Winner, Best Young Economist Award, Italian Society of Economics (2026)

Abstract: When a flood arrives, how much of the damage depends on what was built before it? This paper estimates the causal effect of ex-ante adaptation on firm revenues. I build a novel dataset linking public investment records (2003–2024) to river and canal geometries, geocoded firms and balance sheets, rainfall, and flood-extent maps, and apply it to the May 2023 flood in Emilia-Romagna. To address the endogenous targeting of adaptation toward high-risk areas, identification exploits systematic differences in completion speed across funding pipelines. Firms inside the flood perimeter lose about 4 percent of their revenue in the year of the event. Completed ex-ante adaptation attenuates the losses associated with extreme rainfall: each €1 million of works completed near a firm preserves about €104,000 of revenue per additional 10 mm of extreme rainfall. No such protection is found for works built to repair past damage, suggesting that prevention and repair are not substitutes.

Publications

Municipal Waste Policies and Spillover Effects, with A. Bucciol and F. Rossi
Environmental and Resource Economics, 88, 2263–2286, 2025. doi:10.1007/s10640-025-01013-w

The Effect of COVID Policy Restrictions on Donations during the Sustainable Context, with G. Borello
Journal of Business Research, 177, 114615, 2024. doi:10.1016/j.jbusres.2024.114615

Working Papers

Classifying Hydrological Risk Adaptation Policies with Large Language Models: The HYDROADAPT Dataset. doi:10.2139/ssrn.5319205 · **Research grant, University of Bologna, funded by Unicredit (2025)**

Work in Progress

Building for the Future: The Effects of Climate-Resilient Codes on Housing Supply and Affordability, with H. Druckenmiller, P. Liao and M. Walls

Spatial Bunching of Development Outside Floodplain Boundaries, with H. Druckenmiller

Self-Regulation and Agricultural Resilience, with T. Sonno and D. Zufacchi

Mandatory Catastrophe Insurance and Private Adaptation, with L. Forni

Seminars and Conferences

LSE Environmental Week, London School of Economics; 3rd Early Career Workshop on Applied Environmental and Climate Economics; Annual Scientific Meeting, Italian Society of Economics, Cagliari; Fourteenth IAERE Annual Conference, Trento — 2026
Verona Early Career Workshop in Economics — 2025
Eleventh IAERE Annual Conference, Naples — 2023
International Workshop in Spatial Econometrics, Université de Lille — 2022

Professional Service

Referee: *Journal of Environmental Economics and Management*, *Environmental and Resource Economics*

Ph.D. Representative, Department of Economics, University of Bologna 2024 – 2025

Organizer, weekly department five-a-side football match 2024 – 2025

Organizer, Premio Katundo Opera Seconda, literary prize for second works of fiction 2025 – 2026

Education

AI in Research Bootcamp, California Institute of Technology 2026
Summer school

Econometrics meets Natural Language Processing, Italian Society of Econometrics and Bank of Italy 2024
Summer school

Financial Economics and Climate Sustainability, Harvard Business School 2024
Online doctoral course. Grade: 30 cum laude/30

M.Sc. in Economics, University of Verona 2019 – 2021
Grade: 110 cum laude/110. Advisor: Alessandro Bucciol
Thesis: *Effects of Pay-as-you-throw Tariffs on Waste Sorting and Illegal Dumping in the Veneto Region*

Erasmus Program, Stockholm University 2018 – 2019

B.Sc. in Economics and Business, University of Verona 2016 – 2019
Grade: 110 cum laude/110. Advisor: Paolo Pertile
Thesis: *Gambling and Socio-economic Conditions across Italian Municipalities: an Empirical Approach*

Teaching Assistance

University of Bologna
M.Sc. Environmental Policy (Alessandro Tavoni) 2025 – 2026
M.Sc. Microeconomics (Nadia Burani) 2024 – 2026

Johns Hopkins University, SAIS Europe
M.Sc. International Economics I (Emanuela Carbonara) 2024

University of Verona
B.Sc. Econometrics (Diego Lubian) 2020
B.Sc. Microeconomics (Simone Quercia) 2020
B.Sc. Statistics (Francesca Rossi) 2019 – 2020

Research Assistance

Research Fellow, University of Verona 2021 – 2022
ReDoCrowd: Rules of Accountability and Transparency for the Covid19-related Donation-Crowdfunding

Research Assistant, Polo Scientifico Didattico "Studi sull'impresa", Vicenza 2020
Waste Tourism across Municipalities in Veneto: a Spatial Econometrics Approach

Skills

Software: Stata, Python, R, Tableau, LaTeX (advanced)
Languages: Italian (native), English (C1), Spanish (beginner)

References

Alessandro Bucciol
Full Professor, University of Verona
Head of the Department of Economics
alessandro.bucciol@univr.it

Hannah Druckenmiller
Assistant Professor, California Institute of Technology
NBER Faculty Research Fellow
hdruck@caltech.edu

Lorenzo Forni
Full Professor of Economic Policy, University of Padova
Head of Prometeia Associazione
lorenzo.forni@unipd.it

Vincenzo Scrutinio
Assistant Professor, University of Bologna
IZA Research Fellow, CEP-LSE Associate
vincenzo.scrutinio@unibo.it